令和７年度一般選抜前期日程

英　語　問　題　紙

注意事項

1. 試験開始の合図があるまで，この問題紙を開いてはいけません。
2. 英語の問題紙は，12ページあります。
3. 解答用紙は４枚あります。
4. 受験番号は，監督者の指示に従って，解答用紙の指定された箇所に必ず記入しなさい。
5. 受験番号および解答以外のことを解答用紙に書いてはいけません。
6. 解答はすべて解答用紙の指定された欄に書きなさい。
7. 解答用紙のみを提出しなさい。問題紙は持ち帰りなさい。

問題 1 次の英文を読み，問いに日本語で答えなさい。

The nightmare scenario

In the wake of my father's death, I started having weird, unpleasant dreams.

That's as much as I'll say about them, because, let's be honest, the phrase 'Let me tell you about my dream' is one virtually guaranteed to cause the listener's eyes to glaze over, as they're consumed by a wave of extreme disinterest.

Still, I will say that having more upsetting and vivid dreams than usual was rather annoying, given all the other emotional issues I was trying to get to grips with. In some ways it is unsurprising, though: the sudden loss of a loved one undeniably makes your daily life a fog of emotional turmoil and confusion, so why *wouldn't* your dreams follow suit? It's the same brain responsible for everything, after all.

I'm not alone, either. The COVID-19 pandemic has led to people worldwide being more scared, confused, anxious, angry, and stressed than usual. The overall mental health impacts will take years to uncover and unpack, but interestingly, at the time of writing, I'm seeing a lot of people online opening up about the weird, unsettling dreams they're regularly having.

(1)The obvious conclusion here is that the emotions we experience while awake significantly influence the dreams we have when asleep. Of course, not all emotions are good. Some are very negative, so would presumably lead to very negative dreams: nightmares.

We've all experienced nightmares. They're deeply scary and unpleasant, but also remarkably common. Data suggests that between 2 per cent and 6 per cent of us experience them on a weekly basis.

Why, though? While negative emotions are useful, and often more stimulating than positive ones, our brains also work hard to suppress or limit their impact and influence, via things like the fading affect bias. So, if emotions like fear are our brain's way of knowing what we should avoid, why does that same brain *induce* fear in our dreams? Is there a purpose for (2)this *baffling function, or is it a sign of something going wrong?

Luckily, while hearing about someone's *specific* dream is tedious, dreams and dreaming as a process are the subject of much interest, including for many scientists. So, there's a lot of research out there about how dreams and nightmares work. While the specific nature and processes at work are still debated, it's widely agreed that they're an important, possibly even vital, aspect of how our brains deal with memories and emotions.

Sleep has four distinct stages: non-REM stages 1, 2, and 3, followed by REM (rapid eye movement) sleep. Dreaming occurs during REM sleep (with some rare exceptions). The longer we're in REM sleep, the more we dream, and the REM stage seems to last longer each time we go through the cycle in a typical night. This means REM sleep lasts longest at the end of the sleep cycle; hence (3)we're often woken up from a dream by our morning alarm.

The bigger question of why we dream is tied into how our brains deal with memory and emotion. Dreams have an important role in memory consolidation; after all, what better time to †bolster existing memories than when we're unconscious, the one time when no new memories are being formed? Consolidating memories while we're awake is like repairing a road while cars are still driving on it: it *can* be done, but it's much harder.

While our dreaming brain is integrating new memories, linking them to older, established ones, it 'activates' them, to an extent, meaning we re-

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*baffling　不可解な
†bolster　強化する

experience them. This happens regularly when we remember things while awake, but our real-time consciousness takes up most of our brain activity. When we're asleep, though, our consciousness and senses are largely 'shut down'. This means the memories being triggered while dreaming, and the experiences they entail, have the brain all to themselves. (4)That's why dreams seem so 'real' while we're experiencing them: they're activating memories, but without our consciousness overshadowing them, these memories are a lot more '‡immersive'.

However, we've seen that each memory is an §amalgamation of elements. A memory is a combination of specific sensory, emotional, and cognitive experiences, stored in the brain as collections of **synaptic connections. This allows certain elements to be used in multiple memories, saving space and resources in the brain.

It also means that not every element of a memory need be activated when we dream. ††Discrete elements of memories are triggered individually, and linked to relevant elements of other separate memories, strengthening the integration, utility, and usefulness of the materials stored in our memory.

This can explain why what happens in our dreams is often so bizarre: they're distinct aspects of existing memories, being combined and triggered in atypical and unusual patterns. The people you dream about are often amalgamations of other people you've encountered, the places mashups of where you've been while awake, and so on.

And there doesn't need to be any real-world logic as to which bits of memories are linked together. For instance, if you've a memory of singing and a memory of being underwater, the dreaming brain can activate both, giving

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‡immersive　実際に体験しているような
§amalgamation　融合，合成
**synaptic connection　複数の神経細胞がシナプスを形成して結合すること
††discrete　不連続の，別々の

us the dreaming experience of singing underwater, even though human physiology and the laws of physics don't allow that.

But even when our dreams include such outlandish scenarios, our dreaming self rarely thinks anything unusual is happening. This makes sense: if our dreams are entirely constructed from elements of memories, then our dreaming brain technically *isn't experiencing anything new*.

The pivotal role of sleep and dreaming in memory processing and consolidation has been demonstrated in several interesting studies. One, invoking the power of smell, exposed subjects to the smell of roses while they performed specific learning tasks. After this, some subjects had the rose smell pumped into their rooms as they slept in the lab overnight, while others did not. The study showed that those who were exposed to the smell in their sleep performed a lot better on assessments of learning the next day.

Does this mean that if you have a scented candle in your room while you study, then have the same lit candle in your room while you sleep, you'll retain the information better? (5)This experiment suggests so. I certainly wouldn't recommend sleeping with an open flame in your room, though.

(Adapted from *Emotional Ignorance: Misadventures in the Science of Emotion*, by Dr Dean Burnett)

問 1　下線部(1)の内容を本文に即して述べなさい。

問 2　下線部(2)の内容を本文に即して述べなさい。

問 3　下線部(3)の理由を本文に即して述べなさい。

問 4　下線部(4)の理由を本文に即して述べなさい。

問 5　下線部(5)の根拠となる研究結果を本文に即して簡潔に述べなさい。

問題 2 Read the following text and answer the questions **in English** according to the text.

The Child-Nutrition Myth That Just Won't Die

When my 2-year-old began favoring string cheese and croutons over peas and cauliflower, I tried to get creative. First, I mimicked the artsy approach to vegetables I remembered from childhood, starting with the classic ants on a log and then advancing to cucumber caterpillars and *hummus monsters with carrot teeth. My toddler was only mildly amused. Next I turned to persuasion, repeating just how delicious †bok choy is and how strong spinach would make her. On most days, I was lucky to get a single bite of something green within an inch of her mouth.

So I turned to Instagram and TikTok, where I quickly noticed that one veggie trick triumphed above all others: Hide the vegetables your child dislikes in the dishes they love. Does your kid like pancakes? Mix a little powdered spinach into those. ‡Mac and cheese? That distinct orange color could come from carrots. You can even disguise cauliflower and broccoli in pizza sauce.

The sneak-it-in strategy predates social media. Authors of parenting cookbooks, such as *Deceptively Delicious* and *The Sneaky Chef: Simple Strategies for Hiding Healthy Foods in Kids' Favorite Meals*, made the rounds on TV programs like *The Oprah Winfrey Show* and the *Today* show back in §the late aughts. The fact that stealth cooking has remained so popular is

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*hummus　水煮したヒヨコマメにオリーブオイルやレモン汁などを加え，ペースト状にした中東料理
†bok choy　チンゲン菜
‡mac and cheese　マカロニ・アンド・チーズ，マカロニをチーズソース（主にチェダー）で和えた米国料理
§the late aughts　2000 年代（2000 ～ 2009）の後期，通常 2007 年から 2009 年を指す。

amazing when you consider how much work it is. You might spend an extra hour cooking, say, chicken nuggets from scratch with pureed beets tucked inside — versus buying a bag of regular chicken nuggets from the supermarket. But if it helps your toddler get their recommended cup or cup and a half of vegetables each day, it's worth it, right?

The nutrition experts I spoke with say it's not. "Children by and large don't need us to go to those lengths to get vegetables into them," Laura Thomas, a nutritionist who directs the London Centre for Intuitive Eating, told me.

Vegetables, of course, have many health benefits. Some studies have linked eating vegetables to a decreased risk of several chronic diseases, including heart disease. But these studies look at veggie consumption across many years, not strictly what you eat as a toddler. And even though many children in the U.S. aren't meeting dietary guidelines on vegetables, Thomas said that doesn't necessarily mean they are undernourished. A large national study published in 2018 found that toddlers, despite their reputation for veggie-hatred, on average consume enough calcium, vitamin A, and iron. They tend to be low on **potassium and fiber, but children (and adults, for that matter) can absorb such crucial nutrients from meat, nuts, beans, whole grains, and other nongreen foods. "There is almost nothing inherent to a vegetable that you can't get in other foods," Thomas said.

Disregarding vegetables isn't an ideal long-term solution, because many of the foods that we tend to eat in their place are high in calories and low in fiber. But in the short term, accepting alternatives can help your toddler survive their pickiest stages without getting ††scurvy. And crucially, hiding veggies in

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**potassium　カリウム
††scurvy　壊血病

bread- or meat- or sugar-heavy foods still means your kid is eating a lot of bread or meat or sugar. No amount of vegetables can counteract the detrimental effects of excess sugar.

Prominent nutritionists and child-development specialists alike have been telling parents for years to stop pressuring and tricking kids into eating vegetables. Yet health-conscious parents just can't seem to put down the blender — which might say less about picky kids and more about the years of health messaging and fad diets their elders have endured. "All of these Millennials who grew up with 'clean eating' haven't really thrown off that baggage," Thomas said. Ellyn Satter, who for decades has been an expert on feeding and raising healthy kids, puts it more bluntly: "The belief is that if you hide vegetables in your child's food, they won't get fat and they're going to live forever."

Covertly shredding beets into meatballs and sneaking pureed veggies into our children's mouths with whipped-cream chasers isn't just pointless, Satter and other nutritionists say. The approach can even be counterproductive. "The goal of child nutrition is not to get children to eat everything they're supposed to today. It is to help them to learn to enjoy a variety of healthy food for a lifetime," Satter told me. And everything scientists know about how to do that stands in contrast to grinding vegetables into an indistinguishable pulp and masking them with other flavors.

Experts told me that if you consistently prepare and eat meals with your kids that contain a variety of foods — including disliked vegetables — without pressuring them to taste or swallow anything, they'll eventually learn to eat

most of what's offered. Satter originally outlined this approach back in the 1980s, and told me that it works primarily because it creates trust between parent and child. "The child needs to trust their parents to let them determine what to eat or not eat from what the parents offer," she said. If your child discovers that you've been hiding cauliflower in their tater tots or telling them tiny pieces of broccoli are actually green sprinkles, Satter said, you could rupture that trust, and your child may become more wary of the foods you serve or develop negative associations with vegetables.

Nearly 40 years after Satter outlined her feeding method, pediatric nutritionists continue to be wary of the trust-destroying potential of veggie-sneaking. Rafael Pérez-Escamilla, a public-health professor at Yale, told me that even if your child is going through a mac-and-cheese phase (as his son did for many years in the 90's), he would never advise hiding vegetables in other foods. "Surround your child with healthy foods, but let the kid decide. Let the kid touch the food, smell the food; let the kid learn to eat when he or she is hungry and stop eating when he or she knows he is full," he said. "It's easier said than done, but it works."

The hands-off approach certainly takes less physical work, but Pérez-Escamilla is right that it can be a real emotional struggle. As a parent, I'm still tempted to soothe my anxiety by sneaking kale into a smoothie, and reluctant to cook creamed spinach for my toddler over and over only to be rejected each time. But I have learned to find some comfort in acting as a role model instead of a micromanager.

Over the past few months, I've quit slipping broccoli into pasta sauce and

started offering it as part of dinner. Sometimes my toddler takes a nibble; sometimes she doesn't. I've noticed that the less I show I care, the more she experiments on her own.

(Adapted from *The Atlantic*, May 29, 2024, by Lauren Silverman)

Question 1. Why did the author give up the artsy approach to vegetables?

Question 2. Explain the sneak-it-in strategy.

Question 3. Explain what is meant by "There is almost nothing inherent to a vegetable that you can't get in other foods."

Question 4. According to Ellyn Satter, what is the most important aim in child nutrition?

Question 5. According to Rafael Pérez-Escamilla, what is the hands-off approach?

問題 3 Write an essay **in English**. Imagine you wake up and discover a hidden talent you never knew you had. What is your new talent and how does it affect your social relationships and your future career plan(s)? Describe potential problems caused by your new talent.